

CHỦ ĐỀ 8

THE UNEXPLORED EARTH

Mục tiêu cần đạt được của bài dạy về kiến thức, kỹ năng

Về kiến thức:

+ Biết một số từ vựng về trái đất và các hành tinh

+ Hiểu cách sử dụng của mạo từ

Về kỹ năng:

+ Đọc hiểu các văn bản đơn giản về trái đất và các hành tinh

8.1. The earth surface

8.1.1. Listening: Five unexplored places on earth

Warm-up

Quiz: What is this place called?



Answer: The Black Hole of Andros



Answer: Lake Vostok



Answer: Mount Dinpernalason



Answer: The Foja Mountains

Lead-in

Have you ever heard about these places before?

Do you want to know some information about them? Is there anything special about these places?

LISTENING

1. Answer these questions. Tell the class.

1 Which place would you like to visit on the Earth?

2 Is it a place you saw on TV or read about in a magazine?

3 Why do you want to go there?

2. You are going to listen to a radio programme about five unexplored places on Earth. Work in groups of three and decide who is Students A, B and C. Look at the table below and read your sentences. Then, listen and complete your sentences.

3. Listen again. Check and complete the information in the table.

	Student A	Student B	Student C
The Black Hole of Andros	In the Bahamas in the (1) Ocean	The water is (7) °C	The hole is very (12) so it's difficult to (13) what's in there.
Lake Vostok	In (2)	It's (8) square kilometres.	The ice is (14) km deep, so you can't get there.
Mount Dinpernalason	In the (3) of the Himalayan (4)	It's (9) metres high.	Nobody has ever (15) it
The Merume Mountains	In Guyana in (5)	At the end of the (10) kilometre long Mazaruni River	It's one of the most (16) rivers in the world.
The Foja Mountains	In a (6) in Papua, on the island of New Guinea. on the island of New Guinea	The forest is (11) square kilometres.	There are no (17) of the region.

8.1.2. Vocabulary: Land and water

5 Answer these questions about the places in Exercise 2.

1 Which unexplored places are water?

2 Which unexplored places are on land?

3 Which place would you like to explore? Why?

6 Complete the table with these words.

forest island lake mountain ocean river

Areas of water	Areas of land
sea	
.....	
.....	

7 Look at the places in Exercise 6 and think of examples from your country. Which places have you visited? Work in pairs and talk about your places.

There's a forest near my home. We often go there at the weekend.

8.1.3. Grammar: Articles

Definite article

We use the with:

- the names of deserts, seas, oceans and rivers: the Gobi Desert, the North Sea, the Atlantic Ocean, the River Amazon.
- plural names or place names with words like kingdom, states, east/west: the Alps, the Maldives, the United States of America, the United Kingdom, the Far East.

No article

We use no article with the names of continents, countries, lakes or a single mountain: Europe, Brazil, Lake Como, Mount Everest.

8 Look at the grammar box. Match the places (1-8) with the categories (a-h). Then write the or - (no article) for each place.

- 1 .. *the*.. Bahamas
 - 2 Mount Kilimanjaro
 - 3 Pacific Ocean
 - 4 Africa
 - 5 River Nile
 - 6 Merume Mountains
 - 7 Peru
 - 8 Lake Titicaca
- a group of mountains
 - b name of a country
 - c name of a continent
 - d name of a mountain ...2...
 - e name of a river
 - f group of islands ...1...
 - g name of a lake
 - h name of an ocean

9 Look at the article and photo of an ancient map. Complete the text with the or - (no article).

This map of (1) Earth is from the 12th century. At the time, the king of (2) Sicily wanted a map of the countries around (3) Mediterranean Sea. He paid a man called Al-Idrisi to make a map. Al-Idrisi was from (4) Morocco but he lived in (5) Spain. Al-Idrisi interviewed thousands of travellers for information about the sea and the continents, including Arabia (now (6) Middle East), and (7) Asia. The map is difficult to understand because old maps used to put south at the top and north at the bottom. So this map shows (8) North Africa at the top and (9) Europe at the bottom.



10 Turn your book around and look at Al-Idrisi's map. Now north is at the top and south at the bottom. Which continents and countries can you see? Which parts of the world are not on his map?

SPEAKING: A guessing game

11 Work in pairs. Play this guessing game. Think of a place, or choose one from Units 1-12 of this book (e.g. an ocean). Your partner guesses the place by asking yes/no questions only. The winner is the person who guesses with the lowest number of questions.

A: Is it a continent?

A: Is it in Asia?

A: Is it a desert?

B: No.

B: Yes.

B: No ...

8.2. Looking for a new earth

8.1.1. Reading: Looking for a new earth

SPEAKING

1 Work in groups. In the future, do you think humans will live in these places? Choose one answer (A, B or C) for each place, and give reasons.

at the bottom of the ocean on the Moon in the sky

near the Sun on Mars in Antarctica

A Yes, definitely!

B Possibly, but I'm not sure.

C No, never!

READING

3 Read the article. Match the sentences (a-e) to the end of the paragraphs (1-5).

a As a result, they are too hot and gassy or too cold and icy for human life.

b With current space technology, humans will take 766,000 years to travel there.

c And how do you find a 'new Earth'?

d So even if we can't see water on a planet, it's sometimes there.

e Humans can live in those temperatures.



Looking for a New Earth

For thousands of years, humans explored the Earth. Now astronomers are exploring space, looking for new planets or a 'new Earth' for humans to live on in the future. But what will a new Earth look like?

First of all, astronomers look for a star. That's because our own Earth orbits a star (the Sun). When astronomers have found a star, they look for planets around it. In recent years, astronomers have found thousands of new planets orbiting suns. Once they find a new planet, it's also important to measure the distance between the planet and the sun. That's because most planets (unlike our Earth) are either too near to the star or too far away.

When they find a planet in a good position, astronomers look for three things: water, air and rock. Water is important because if humans go there, they will need water to

drink and to grow plants. If you can grow plants, then the plants can produce air for humans to breathe. Finally, astronomers also look for rocks, because water is often under the rocks.

In recent years, astronomers have found a few planets that are very similar to Earth. For example, Gliese 581g is a planet at a safe distance from the nearest star. Astronomers also think it has water and rock. The average temperature is between -31°C and -12°C which is cold, but not colder than Antarctica or the Arctic Circle.

However, there are some differences. Gliese 581g is bigger than the Earth and a year on Gliese 581g is only 37 Earth days instead of 365. And the biggest problem is the distance. Gliese 581g is 18 trillion kilometres from the Earth.

breathe (v): to take air in through your nose or mouth

4 Find these words (1-6) in the article. Then match them with the definitions (a-f).

- | | | |
|---|------------|------------|
| 1 | astronomer | 2 planet |
| 3 | star | 4 orbiting |
| 5 | rock | 6 air |

- a a large round object in space made of rock and metal or gas (e.g. the Earth)
- b a large round object of burning gas in space (e.g. the Sun)
- c someone who studies the planets and stars in space
- d going round a planet or star
- e the gas humans breathe
- f the solid part of the Earth or a planet

5 Read the article again and answer these questions.

- 1 When astronomers look for a new Earth, what do they look for in space?
- 2 When they find a planet, what do they look for?
- 3 How is Gliese 581g similar to the Earth?
- 4 How is Gliese 581g different to the Earth?

8.2.2. Word focus: *How + adj/adv*

8 The article asks, 'How do you find a "new Earth"?' Is the question asking about:

- a age?
- b period of time?
- c the distance?
- d the way to do something?
- e the number?
- f price or quantity?

9 Match these question words with a-fin Exercise 8.

- | | | |
|-----------------|----------------------|-----------------|
| <i>How</i> | <i>How far/ near</i> | <i>How long</i> |
| <i>How many</i> | <i>How much</i> | <i>How old</i> |

Practice 1: Complete the sentences about the places with these words.

desert ocean forest river island sea lake mountain

- 1. Malta is a beautiful Mediterranean Sea.
- 2. The Pacific in the separates Asia, Australasia and the Americas.
- 30% of all the trees in the world are in the borealin Canada, Scandinavia and Russia.
- 3. Kilimanjaro in Tanzania was a volcano and now it's a
..... Wanaka is one of the largest of its kind in New Zealand.
- 4. Nine countries are next to the Baltic
- 5. The Ganges is 2,525 km long and goes from India to Bangladesh.

6. The Gobi covers large parts of southern Mongolia and northern China.

Practice 2: Complete the text about Pluto with these words.

astronomers orbit planets rock star travel

The (1) at the centre of our solar system is called the Sun. There are eight (2) in our solar system, including the Earth. and they all (3) the Sun. But before 2006, there were nine planets.

Pluto was the smallest planet in our solar system. (4) discovered Pluto in 1930. Through a telescope, the surface of Pluto looks different colours. It is made of (5) and ice. Humans could not live on Pluto, so we will probably never (6) there. In 2006. scientists decided Pluto was not a planet.

Pratice 3: Write “the” or — (no article) before these names of places.

1. Maldiva Islands
2. Atlantic Ocean
3. Europe
4. Mount Kilimanjaro
5. Malta
6. River Nile
7. Lake Balaton
8. Peru
9. Sahara Desert
10. Asia
11. River Mississippi
12. Iceland
13. Mediterranean Sea
14. Black Forest
15. Himalayan Mountains